

Master of three-movers

By C.G.S.Narayanan

In the history of Chess composition there were many Russian composers who were not as prolific as a Loshinski or a sRudenko but in the team events they produced high quality problems. Alexandr Kuzovkov, grandmaster and many times world champion in three and more-movers, has chosen Pugachev's three-movers for study in the recent issue of '64'.

S. Pugachyov
Chess Life 1969, 1 prize



Mate in three moves

After 1.Qh5! threatens 2.Nxb2+ Kxd5 3.Qd1#. And four thematic variations with a subtle choice of White's second move and the play of direct and indirect batteries on the third move. 1...Nxc8 2.Qd1! ~Nxb2# (indirectly) 2...Kxd5 3.Ne5# (and now only directly, 3.Nxb2#?), 1...Kxd5 2.Qe2! ~3.Nxb4# (indirect play of two batteries) 2...Kxe4 3.Nxb4#, 2...Kc4 3.Nxf4# (and now two direct battery strikes), 1...Na4 2.Qf3! ~ 3.Nxd6# (indirectly), 2...Kxd5 3.Nd2# (only directly, mo, 3.Nxd6#?), 1... f3 2.Qg4! ~3.Nc3# (direct), 2... Nxd5 3.Nxd6# (direct, with a double check!), 2...Kxd5 3.Nf6# (indirectly, 3.Nc3#?), and another variation, echoing the threat - 1...e2 2.Nd2+ Kxd5 3.Qf3#.

"A magnificent problem, which, in my opinion, belongs to the golden collection of chess compositions. In my youth, this problem simply amazed and fascinated me. Pugachyov was a strong team problemist, always participated in various team tournaments and often achieved victories there" (Kuzovkov)

S.Pugachyov
1st place, IV team event



Mate in three moves

1.Rc4! ~ 2.Ne2+ Kd3 3.Rd4# - mate with a double check, 1...Nxb3 2.Nxb3+ Kd3 3.Rf4#, 2... Kd5 3.Rd4#, 1...fxg4 2.Nc6+ Kd3 3.Rxg4#, 2...Kf5 3.Rf6#, 2... Kd5 3.Rd4#, 1...Nxb4 2.Ne6+ Kd3 3.Rxb4#. Four interesting variations with the consecutive play of two batteries.

Now a problem for solving
S.Pugachyov. 1st place
eChess in USSR 1971



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Siers battery three-movers'
Key 1.Rb5! 1...Kb1/aKa2 2.Qd2 any 3.Qxb2; 1...B any 2.a6; Bc1 2.Qa6 Ba3 3.Qxa3

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